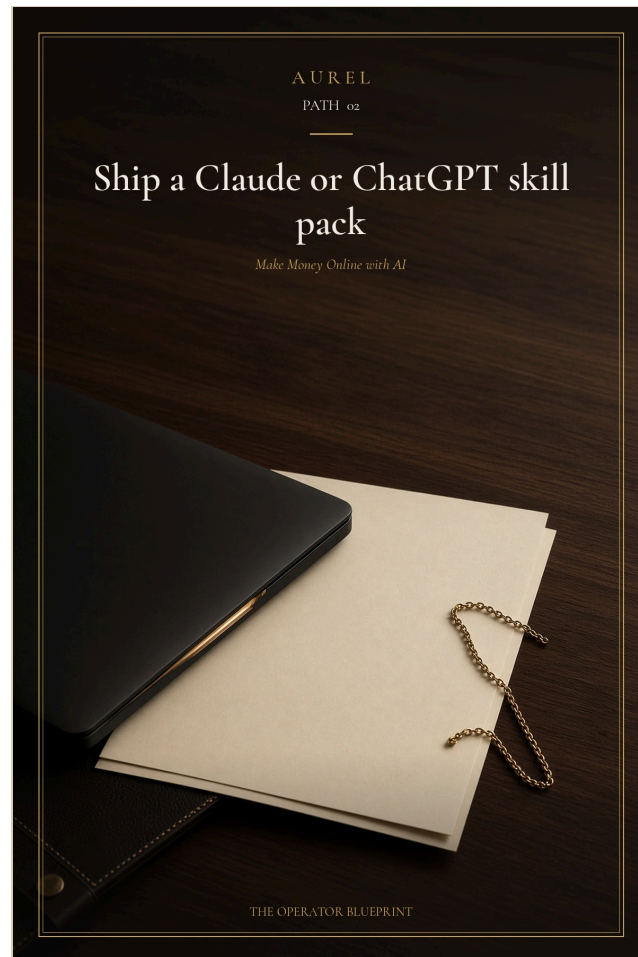


THE OPERATOR SUITE · PATH 02



PATH 02

Ship a Claude or ChatGPT skill pack

They already pay the model. They are paying you to stop starting from zero every Friday.

46 minute read · 10,223 words

Who this is for

People who use Claude, ChatGPT, or Gemini every week and keep rebuilding the same chat for the same job.

Time to first

3–10 days if you already run the job in a chat

Tools

First sale

One \$19 order from someone who used the model this week.

Cash window

\$19–\$39

Leave this alone

Claude Projects or Custom GPTs, a zip of the skill files, a one-page install, Stripe Payment Link or Stan.	A 200-prompt dump with no job in the title. Competing with free GitHub lists on volume.
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What this actually is

Definition

A skill pack is a working stack: instructions the model follows, examples of good output, and a way to install it in under ten minutes. It is not a PDF of prompts. It is closer to a small appliance. Plug it in, get the job.

The buyer has already decided AI is useful. Their pain is the blank window. Your job is to replace that window with a named job: weekly content, invoice follow-up, meeting notes into tasks, a listing description, a study plan. They already pay the model. They are paying you to stop starting from zero.

A skill pack ships as files they can paste or upload: a system-instructions file, one sample input, one sample output, and a one-page install. If you only send a list of prompts, you shipped a weaker version of Niche prompt stacks. This path is the installable version of a job.

What this is not

You are not selling access to a model. They already pay Anthropic or OpenAI. You are not selling 200 clever lines. You are selling the first message being raw material — an overdue invoice list, a messy email thread — and the model already knowing the format, the tone, and when to stop and ask.

You are not selling a playbook. A playbook is the sequence they read. A skill pack is the appliance they install. You are not selling a Custom GPT store listing as the product. Your checkout is yours. Directories are extra, after \$19 works.

You are not selling an API app, a Zapier flow, or a Gmail connection. If you need Zapier, you wandered into Automation setups. If they want you on a call, that is Productized AI service.

Why this works now

People already have a Plus or Pro tab open. What they do not have is a job that survives Friday without rewriting the instructions from memory. Generic skills will be free from the labs. A client-follow-up skill that knows a solo bookkeeper's tone and will not invent an amount is not on the default home screen. You are selling the job, not the concept of a skill.

Models still invent numbers. They still guess a date. They still write a peppy email a bookkeeper would never send. The skill is the freeze of the instructions a careful person would type every Friday, if they had twenty extra minutes, which they do not. Title-match is the distribution. Client follow-up skill for solo bookkeepers is a product. Claude Power Pack is a mood.

Anti-pattern 1: the 200-prompt dump

A zip of clever lines with no job in the title is a toy. You cannot maintain 200. You cannot write failure modes for 200. Sell one job, installed, with a sample so they know it loaded.

Anti-pattern 2: promising every model

Build for one: Claude Projects, Custom GPTs, or Gemini Gems. Say which one on the listing. If a buyer uses the other, refund and point them at the install they would need — or do not sell it to them. Works everywhere is how you get refunds.

Anti-pattern 3: bundling 40 jobs

One job, done, at \$19, outsells a suitcase of half jobs. You cannot version 40 files. You cannot answer 40 kinds of it broke. Narrow is the product. Volume is how this path loses to free GitHub lists.

The deal you keep

You keep three promises. One: a person who did not write it can install it in under ten minutes and get a usable first output from the sample. Two: the skill will not invent named fields (amounts, dates, diagnoses). If a critical field is missing, it asks once, then stops. Three: the checkout title is the job, the price is \$19, and you have bought the zip yourself from a second

email. The buyer keeps one promise: they will run the sample first. You design the install for a tired night. If they need you on a call, it is not a skill pack yet. It is a service.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

Fits if

You use Claude, ChatGPT, or Gemini every week and keep rebuilding the same chat. You have a job you have run in a window more than twice. You can write instructions as if you will never be in the room: role, inputs, output format, quality checks, what to ask if information is missing.

You do not need to be a developer. You need to have finished the job in a chat and been annoyed that you had to re-explain it the next time. You can write a one-page install as clicks. You can record a 20-second screen. You can ask five people who already use the model. You can take \$19 without apologizing.

Skip if

Skip if you have never run the job in a model yourself. Skip if you want to compete with free GitHub lists on volume. Skip if your title would be 200 ChatGPT prompts. That market is noise, and this path loses when you play it.

If you need cash this week and you do not already live in these tools, write a playbook or take a service job first. A skill pack is fast only if the job is already in your fingers. Skip if you cannot write the install without the word repo. Skip if you want to sell a medical, legal, or financial skill that claims it is compliant. This path drafts operational writing. It does not practice.

The honest middle

You do not have to be a prompt engineer. You have to have run the job twice and hated rewriting the instructions the third time. Front-desk follow-up, recruiter shortlists, listing descriptions, meeting-notes-to-tasks: that is enough if you can name the fields you will never invent.

You are not waiting to become technical. You are waiting to have instructions you would hand a tired friend, plus a sample so they know it loaded.

Skills and time

Skills: write system instructions (role, inputs, output, stop rules). Run a real example and a broken example. Write a one-page install as clicks. Zip four files. Make a \$19 Payment Link. Record 20 seconds of screen. Send five asks.

Time if the job is already in your fingers: 3 to 10 days. Two evenings to write and test. One evening to package, checkout, and film. Two evenings to ask. Budget: \$0 if you already pay for the model and have a way to take \$19. You are not shipping an API app.

Two-minute self-test

Answer these out loud. If you stall on two of them, this is not your first path this month.

What is the job in one line, in the buyer's words?

Which tool do they already live in (Claude Projects, Custom GPTs, Gemini Gems)?

What raw material is the first message (invoice list, resume pile, MLS notes)?

Which three fields will you never invent?

Can you write the install as clicks, on one page?

Who are five people who already use the model this week?

Can you run a real example and a broken example tonight?

If you have the job, the tool, the stop rule, and five names, start tonight. If you only have I like prompts, go run a job in a window first.

The buyer on the other side

Not a prompt tourist. They already have a Plus or Pro tab open. They are a bookkeeper, a recruiter, a clinic manager, a realtor who pastes the same messy input every Friday and rewrites the instructions from memory. They will pay \$19 to never start from zero again. They will judge you on the sample run, not on your thumbnail.

The offer, named in one sentence

Fill this first

I help [specific person] finish [named job] in [named tool] in under [time], even if they are not a prompt person. If you cannot name the tool and the job, you do not have a skill pack. You have a vibe.

Specific person is a job plus a setting: solo bookkeeper, not finance people. Named job is the Friday task, named. Named tool is Claude Projects, Custom GPTs, or Gemini Gems. Time is minutes, not a course. Even-if is they are not a prompt person.

Sentences that work

I help solo bookkeepers turn an invoice list into send-ready follow-up emails in Claude in one paste, even if they are not a prompt person.

I help recruiters turn a pile of messy resumes into a scored shortlist in a Custom GPT in one sitting, even if they hate rewriting the instructions every Monday.

I help one-person realtors write listing descriptions from MLS notes in Claude in one paste, even if they freeze on tone.

I help clinic managers turn a messy inbox thread into a task list in Claude in ten minutes, even if they are scared the model will invent a follow-up plan.

I help freelance designers turn a messy client email into a scoped reply plus a next-step list in ChatGPT, even if they lose notes in chat.

Write yours in that shape. One person. One job. One tool. One even-if. Price the job, not the file count.

What they get

A zip: system instructions (or a Custom GPT / Claude Project recipe), a sample input, a sample output, and a one-page install they can follow on a tired night. A 20-second screen recording of blank chat versus the skill, if you have it. Price \$19. They do not get a course. They do not get a community. They get the appliance.

What they do not get

A course. A community. A setup call. A promise it works on every model. 40 jobs in one zip. Inbox connection. An API wrapper. Lifetime updates you will not ship. A medical, court, or tax claim. If they want it connected to Gmail, that is Automation setups, priced as a project. Do not promise inbox connection inside a \$19 zip. If they want you to sit with them and install it, that is Custom project setups or Productized AI service.

Packaging

One job. One tool named on the listing. One \$19 price on the page. Filename the zip after the job: bookkeeper-client-followup-claude-v1.zip. Folder: README (the install), SKILL or INSTRUCTIONS, SAMPLE-INPUT, SAMPLE-OUTPUT. Version number on the README. Checkout title is the job. Thumbnail is the screen recording still.

Do not bundle 40 jobs to justify \$49. One job, done, at \$19, outsells a suitcase of half jobs. \$29 to \$39 is fair when the install is clean, the sample is real, and you include the 20-second screen.

One job, one zip

If you need and to name the job, you have two skills. Split them. Sell the one you can test this week. The second zip is allowed after a stranger has installed the first.

What "done" looks like

Definition

Done means a person who did not write it can install it in under ten minutes and get a usable first output from the sample. If they need you on a call, it is not a skill pack yet. It is a service.

Done also means: instructions with role, inputs, output format, quality checks, and a stop rule for missing facts. A real sample input and sample output in the zip. A broken-example test: it asked, then stopped. One-page install with the actual clicks. Version number on the README. Checkout title is the job. Price \$19. You have bought it from a second email. The zip opens. You have asked five people who already use the model.

Done is not a catalog page with six other ideas. Done is not a 14-page install. Done is not a video instead of a one-pager.

The fairness test

Would you sell this to a tired friend who does that job, at \$19, without hopping on a call? If you would offer to set it up for them, it is not fair yet. Fair means they can follow the one-pager on a tired night and get the sample to match. Fair means you named the tool. Fair means you will not invent amounts, dates, or diagnoses. Fair means a refund in one sentence if it breaks or if they bought the wrong model. Write the install as clicks: where to open, what to paste, what to send first, how they know it worked. If a step is set up your workspace, you hid the work.

The install test

A person who did not write it, ten minutes, sample in, usable out. Time someone. If they need you at minute four, add a screenshot. If they need you at minute twenty because a menu is hidden on mobile, add two screenshots and bump to v1.1. Marcus's first buyer could not find Project instructions on mobile. That is the test.

The quality test

Run the skill on a real example. Save that output as the sample in the zip. Then run it on a broken example — missing amount, missing date, rude client note — and confirm it asks once and stops instead of guessing. Silent guessing is how people lose trust.

The sales test

Checkout title is the job. Price is \$19. You have bought it from a second email. The zip opens. The install PDF is one page. You have asked five people who already use Claude or ChatGPT. Done is not a catalog page with six other ideas.

Not-done-yet list

- A title with no job

- Instructions that guess at missing money or medical facts

No sample input or sample output

You have not run a broken example

Install is 14 pages or a 12-minute video

You promised it works on every model

Checkout untested

You have not asked five people who already use the model

A second skill started before a stranger sale

You included a setup call in the \$19

If three of those are true, you have a draft. Keep going. The first buyer is not your editor.

Pricing that holds

Ranges

\$19 is the default. One \$19 order from someone who used the model this week is the first sale that matters. \$19 matches I already pay for Claude; this saves me the blank window. It is low enough to try tonight and high enough that you will answer a support email.

Do not price at \$9. You will attract collectors who never install it, and you will hate the one-star too simple review from someone who wanted 200 prompts. Stay under \$39 until you have a version history and a second related skill you can bundle.

Why \$19 is the honest default

It is a Friday tax. They already pay the model. \$19 is the freeze of the instructions they rewrite every week. If you are ashamed of \$19, you either bundled 40 jobs or you do not believe the blank window is expensive. Cut to one job, or run the job yourself one more Friday. Round numbers. Price on the button. Do not DM for price.

When \$29 to \$39 is honest

Raise when you have: a 20-second screen, a real sample, failure modes in the instructions, and at least one stranger who installed it without you. That is a better product, not a different mood. Stay under \$39 until you have a version history and a second related skill you can bundle. Raise because the file does more, not because you got bored of \$19. Email v1.1 free to people who already paid.

Refunds in one sentence

If it breaks, or if you bought the wrong model, email me and I will refund.

You will refund almost nobody if the sample runs and the listing names the tool. Refund the ChatGPT buyer of a Claude skill fast and without a speech. Then make the title clearer. Refunds for the wrong model are a listing problem.

What you never charge

Never charge extra for lifetime updates you will not ship. Never add a \$97 with a setup call on day one unless you mean to run Productized AI service instead. Never charge a second time for v1.1; email it. Never charge \$9. Never promise it works on every model to justify a higher price. Never charge for a Gmail connection inside a \$19 zip.

Worked dollars

Marcus sells the bookkeeper follow-up skill at \$19. Day 3 he asks five people. Two of the five buy: \$38. A stranger buys on day 6 after he replies to a tweet about Claude inventing invoice amounts, with the result (amounts correct, tone plain) and the link in his profile: \$19. One refund from someone who only uses ChatGPT: minus \$19. He bolds Claude Projects on the listing. Week 2 he ships v1.1 with two mobile screenshots and emails both remaining buyers. He does not raise yet. Month 1: five sales at \$19, one refund. Net \$76. That is the path. Not a launch. One appliance that works.

If he had started at \$79 with no screen and no sample, he would have zero installs. If he had started at \$9, he would have collectors. \$19 is the door. After a stranger has installed it and he has the screen and the failure modes, he can raise new sales to \$29. Email v1.1 free. Do not invent a \$49 pack of 40 jobs.

The first 72 hours

Day 1 morning: pick the job and write the room

Pick one job you have done in a chat more than twice. Open a new project. Write the system instructions as if you will never be in the room: role, inputs they must paste, output format, quality checks, what to ask if information is missing. Name the three fields you will never invent. Put that list in the instructions, not in a blog post about your process.

Paste this to get a first draft of the instructions, then rewrite every line in your voice:

Write system instructions for [tool] that a tired [person] will use. Job: [job]. The user's first message is only the raw material: [what they paste]. You will return [format]. If [critical field] is missing, ask once, then stop. Do not invent numbers. Include three quality checks you run before you show the draft.

Day 1 afternoon: run a real example and a broken one

Run it on a real example. Save the output as the sample. Then run it on a broken example — missing amount, missing date, rude client note — and confirm it asks once and stops instead of guessing. If it guesses, the instructions failed. Rewrite the stop rule. Do not ship a silent guesser. Blur names. Keep texture.

Day 1 night: the one-page install

Write the install as clicks: where to open, what to paste, what to send first, how they know it worked. One page. Numbered clicks. One screenshot if a menu is hidden. A line that says you will know it worked when the sample output looks like this. If they have to watch a 12-minute video, you wrote a course. Cut it. Stop at midnight. You have instructions, two runs, and an install. That is a good day.

Day 2: package, checkout, film

README, skill file, sample in, sample out. Zip. Filename after the job: bookkeeper-client-followup-claude-v1.zip. Price \$19. Stripe Payment Link or Stan. Buy it from a second email.

Record a 20-second screen: blank chat versus the skill. Same paste, two very different first drafts. No music. No intro. The last two seconds are the \$19 line. Phone screen record is enough.

Day 3: five asks, not fifty features

Ask five people who already use Claude or ChatGPT. I built a [job] skill for [person]. \$19, ten-minute install. If you want it: [link]. If not, ignore. Do not explain the catalog of other ideas you have. Help in one thread where people complain about the job. Link stays in the profile. Do not dump the zip in a comment.

The 72-hour list

- One job, written as system instructions
- One real example output in the zip
- One broken-example test: it asked, then stopped
- One-page install a tired person can follow
- Twenty-second screen recording
- Five asks, not fifty features

The path, step by step

Step 1. Watch how the buyer actually works

If they live in email, do not build a Notion skill. If they live in Claude on a phone, the install cannot assume a desktop sidebar they have never opened. Sit with one real run of the job. Write down the raw material they paste and the file they want out.

Step 2. Write the skill so the first message is just the raw material

The skill should not need a prompt engineer on their side. If they have to write a paragraph of instructions after they install it, you failed. Role in one line. Inputs named. Output format named. Three quality checks. A stop rule for missing facts.

Step 3. Add failure modes

If the invoice amount is missing, ask once, then stop. Silent guessing is how people lose trust. List the three fields you will never invent. Put that list in the instructions, not in a blog post about your process. No be helpful filler. No claim that it replaces a bookkeeper, a lawyer, or a clinician. It drafts. They send.

Step 4. Version the file

v1 is allowed to be narrow. You will ship v1.1 after the first buyer. Put v1.0 in the README and the filename. When you fix install wording, bump it. Buyers should know they can re-download.

Step 5. Package the zip

README, skill or instructions file, sample input, sample output. That is enough. The README is the one-page install, not a manifesto. Filename the zip after the job: bookkeeper-client-followup-claude-v1.zip.

Step 6. Checkout title is the job

Thumbnail is the screen recording still. Description names the tool, the install time, and the sample. Works in Claude Projects. Ten-minute install. Sample invoice list included. Price \$19 on the page. Refund line on the page. One product.

Step 7. Record the 20-second screen

Left: blank chat, slow. Right or after: paste the raw list, get the follow-ups. No music. No intro. The last two seconds are the \$19 line and the link. The still from second 3 is the thumbnail. Phone screen record is enough.

Step 8. Sell where those users already complain

X threads, Reddit help posts, Discord. Help first. Link in profile. Do not dump the zip in a comment. Dump the result of the job, then let the profile hold the buy link.

Step 9. Five personal asks to people who already use the model

I built a [job] skill for [person]. \$19, ten-minute install. If you want it: [link]. If not, ignore. First sale is allowed to be someone you know. Ask: did the sample run?

Step 10. After purchase, a three-line email

Install, test with the sample, reply if it breaks. That reply is your product roadmap. Do not add a course. Do not add a community.

Step 11. Fix whatever the first buyer could not install

Ship v1.1. Same checkout, new zip. Email the people who already bought. Two screenshots for a hidden mobile menu is a better product than a second skill.

Step 12. Do not add a second skill until this one has a stranger sale

One appliance that works beats a store of toys. If nobody bought, the title or the tool is wrong. Ask one of the five: would you even install this? Then change the title, not the whole stack.

Step 13. Date the README

Tested on Claude, [month year]. When the model moves, run the sample again. If it breaks, fix, bump the version, email buyers. That is the job after the first sale. It is also why you do not sell 40 jobs in one zip — you cannot maintain them.

Step 14. Raise only when the file does more

After a stranger has installed it and you have the screen and the failure modes, move new sales to \$29. Email v1.1 free. Raise because the file does more, not because you got bored of \$19.

Step 15. Only then consider the next shape

A prompt stack if they want to paste instead of install. A playbook if they want the sequence written down. A template if they want the checklist as a filled file. A service if they say can you just set it up for me, at a different number. Not before a stranger install.

Step 16. Stop

Do not open a membership to avoid shipping v1. Do not add a \$97 setup call on day one. Do not start a second skill because week 2 felt quiet. Quiet is usually five more asks and a clearer title. Ship at the bar. Fix after the first install trip-up.

A worked example

Marcus, solo bookkeepers, \$19

Marcus is a solo bookkeeper. Every Friday he writes the same follow-up emails: invoice sent, invoice 7 days late, invoice 21 days late, polite close-the-loop. He used to paste a messy spreadsheet into Claude and spend twenty minutes restating the tone. He ships a Claude skill: Client follow-up for solo bookkeepers. Price: \$19.

His one sentence: I help solo bookkeepers turn an invoice list into send-ready follow-up emails in Claude in one paste, even if they are not a prompt person.

Calendar: days 1 to 14

Day 1 morning: he writes the instructions. Role: follow-ups for a solo bookkeeper. Inputs: client name, invoice number, amount, days late, last contact. Output: subject line plus a short email in plain voice. Never invent an amount or a date. If amount or days late is missing, ask once, then stop. Three tones: reminder, firm, final. Default to reminder unless days late is over 14.

Day 1 afternoon: he runs eight fake invoices, names blurred from a real week. He runs a ninth with a missing amount. The skill asks, then stops. He saves SAMPLE-INPUT and SAMPLE-OUTPUT. Night: one-page INSTALL as clicks.

Day 2: zip. Filename: bookkeeper-client-followup-claude-v1.zip. Stripe Payment Link titled Client follow-up skill for solo bookkeepers — install in 10 minutes. He buys it from a second email. The zip opens on his phone. He records 20 seconds: blank chat (write follow-ups for these invoices) versus the Project with the skill. Same list, two very different first drafts. Left one invented an amount. Right one asked.

Day 3: five asks. Two other bookkeepers in a Slack, his old firm colleague, a freelancer Discord, and a person who had tweeted Claude keeps making up invoice amounts. He does not pitch

a catalog.

What is in the zip

Four files. Nothing else. Filename: bookkeeper-client-followup-claude-v1.zip.

SKILL.txt, the whole file

This is what he pastes into Project instructions. Steal the shape. Rewrite every line for the job you actually do.

You write follow-up emails for a solo bookkeeper. You are not the bookkeeper. You draft. They send.

The user's first message is the raw invoice list. They will not write extra instructions. Do not ask them to prompt you. If the paste is not an invoice list, say so and stop. Do not switch jobs.

Inputs you expect, one invoice per line or block:

- Client name
- Invoice number
- Amount, including cents if they typed cents
- Days late, or invoice date so you can count from today
- Last contact, if they have it (what was sent and when)
- Optional one-line note from the bookkeeper

Output, for each invoice, in this order:

1. Tone used: reminder, firm, or final
2. Subject line
3. Email body, 80 to 140 words, plain voice
4. A one-line why-this-tone the bookkeeper can ignore

Tone rules:

- Just sent, or 1 to 13 days late: reminder. Assume they forgot. No threat. No per my last email.
- 14 to 20 days late: firm. Name the amount, the invoice number, and a pay-by date 7 days from today. Still polite.

- 21 or more days late: final. Still plain. Ask them to reply with a date or a problem. Do not threaten collections, lawyers, or credit reporting. The bookkeeper will decide that in person.

Voice. Short sentences. No I hope this message finds you well. No exclamation points. No just circling back more than once in the whole batch. Match these two real sentences: Invoice 1042 for \$1,240 is still open. When you have a minute, reply with a date I can put on the calendar. And: If something on this invoice is wrong, tell me and I will fix it.

Never invent amounts, invoice numbers, dates the user did not give you, payment promises the client did not make, or fees and late penalties the user did not type.

If amount or days late (or invoice date) is missing on a row, ask once for that row, then skip it. Do not draft an email with a blank or a guess. Say: Row [n]: I need [field] before I draft this one. Then continue with the rows you can finish.

Quality checks before you show the draft:

1. Every amount in an email matches the list exactly, including cents.
2. Every invoice number matches the list exactly.
3. No row with a missing amount or missing days late has an email.
4. Tone matches the days-late rule, not the mood of a note.
5. No email is longer than 140 words.

SAMPLE-INPUT.txt

Eight rows. Names blurred from a real week. Ugly on purpose. One missing amount. One all-caps note.

Row 1. Rivera Dental. INV-1042. \$1,240.00. 3 days late. Last contact: invoice sent 8/1. Note: pays slow every time.

Row 2. Holt Mechanical. INV-1048. \$680.50. 9 days late. Last contact: invoice sent 7/28.
Note: none.

Row 3. Parkside Vet. INV-1039. \$2,100.00. 16 days late. Last contact: voicemail 8/5. Note: they asked for a copy last month.

Row 4. North End Salon. INV-1051. \$315.00. 0 days late, just sent today. Last contact: invoice sent today. Note: new client.

Row 5. Quinn Roofing. INV-1028. \$4,880.00. 22 days late. Last contact: reminder emailed 8/3.

Note: OWNER IS TRAVELING, WILL PAY WHEN BACK.

Row 6. Little Oak Daycare. INV-1044. \$960.00. 11 days late. Last contact: none. Note: PO missing on their side, they still want the work billed.

Row 7. Greenfield PT. INV-1050. Amount missing. 8 days late. Last contact: invoice sent 7/30.

Note: I forgot to type the amount, do not guess.

Row 8. Harbor Bike Shop. INV-1033. \$1,075.25. 18 days late. Last contact: firm email 8/6. Note: they disputed a line last year, this invoice is clean.

He kept cents on two rows. He kept the all-caps row. He kept the missing amount. A perfect table would have made the skill look smart and fail on Friday.

SAMPLE-OUTPUT.txt

What the skill produced on that paste, after Marcus confirmed he would send rows 1-6 and 8.

Row 7 is the ask, not an email.

Row 1. Tone: reminder. Subject: Invoice 1042 for \$1,240.00. Body starts: Invoice 1042 for \$1,240.00 is still open. When you have a minute, reply with a date I can put on the calendar. Why this tone: 3 days late.

Row 2. Tone: reminder. Subject: Invoice 1048 for \$680.50. Short, plain, no pep. Why this tone: 9 days late.

Row 3. Tone: firm. Subject: Invoice 1039 for \$2,100.00 — need a date. Body names the voicemail, names a pay-by date 7 days out, offers to resend a copy. Why this tone: 16 days late.

Row 4. Tone: reminder. Subject: Invoice 1051 for \$315.00. One short thanks-and-here-it-is, no welcome-aboard paragraph. Why this tone: just sent.

Row 5. Tone: final. Subject: Invoice 1028 for \$4,880.00. Body stays plain. Asks for a date or a problem. Does not threaten. Does not scold the all-caps note. Why this tone: 22 days late.

Row 6. Tone: reminder. Subject: Invoice 1044 for \$960.00. Offers to add the PO if they send it. Does not invent a PO. Why this tone: 11 days late.

Row 7. No email. Row 7: I need the amount before I draft this one.

Row 8. Tone: firm. Subject: Invoice 1033 for \$1,075.25 — need a date. Does not mention last year's dispute. Why this tone: 18 days late.

Marcus actually sent seven of these after a human pass. He changed one subject line. He left the rest. That is the sample. Not a fantasy Friday.

INSTALL.pdf, one page

Title: Client follow-up for solo bookkeepers — Claude Projects — v1.0. Tested on Claude, [month year]. Ten minutes.

Open claude.ai on a laptop this once.

Left sidebar: Projects. If you are on a phone, open the menu; Projects may be hiding there. If you still cannot find it, use a laptop for install, then chat from the phone after the project exists.

New Project. Name: Client follow-up.

Open custom instructions / Project instructions for that project.

Paste the entire SKILL.txt. Save.

Start a new chat inside the project. Do not chat outside it.

Paste SAMPLE-INPUT.txt as the first message. Send. Do not add extra instructions.

Open SAMPLE-OUTPUT.txt. Compare amounts and invoice numbers. Row 7 must ask for the amount. It must not invent one.

If it matches, paste your own list the same way. Read every amount before you send an email. You send. The skill drafts.

If it does not match, reply to the purchase email with a screenshot. Do not fight the model for twenty minutes.

That is the whole page. Two screenshots on v1.1: the sidebar Projects item, and the custom instructions box. No twelve-minute video.

How he sold it, with dollars

Two of the five bought on day 3. \$38. A stranger bought on day 6 after he replied to that tweet with the result (amounts correct, tone plain) and left the link in his profile. \$19. First stranger sale.

The first buyer could not find Project instructions on mobile. Marcus added two screenshots to INSTALL.pdf, bumped to v1.1, and emailed both buyers. He did not start a second skill for tax organizers. Not yet.

Week 2: one more sale from the same tweet, recycled. \$19. One refund from someone who only uses ChatGPT. Minus \$19. He bolds Claude Projects in the title. Month 1: five sales at \$19, one refund. Net \$76. He asks every buyer: did the sample run? Two said yes. One said the mobile menu was the trip-up, which v1.1 already fixed.

The mistake and the recovery

The mobile install was the whole product problem in week 1. Not the instructions. Not the price. Two screenshots. v1.1. Email. He did not add a 12-minute video. He did not add a second skill. Shipped artifact: a four-file zip, a one-page install with two screenshots, a 20-second screen, a \$19 Payment Link. He still has not built the tax-organizer skill. Nobody who installed follow-up asked for it.

Copy you can actually send

Swap the job. Keep the tool name. Do not add hype. Paste these as they are. Fill the brackets. Send.

DM

I built a [job] skill for [person] who already uses Claude. Ten-minute install, \$19. If that is useful: [link]. If not, no need to reply.

Post

I wasted two hours prompting this. The skill does it in one paste. \$19.

Or, with the screen still: Blank chat vs the follow-up skill. Same invoice list. Left one invented an amount. Right one asked. \$19, install in 10 minutes. Built for solo bookkeepers. Not a prompt dump.

Listing

Title: Client follow-up skill for solo bookkeepers — install in 10 minutes.

Body:

What you get: Claude Project instructions, a sample invoice list, a sample of the emails, and a one-page install.

What you do: paste your list. Get send-ready follow-ups. It will not invent amounts.

What you need: Claude (Projects). Not a prompt engineer.

Price: \$19. Instant zip. Email me if it breaks.

Email after purchase

Subject: install, then test with the sample

Open the INSTALL page. Ten minutes.

Run SAMPLE-INPUT first. Match it against SAMPLE-OUTPUT so you know it loaded.

Then paste your own list. If it breaks, reply to this with a screenshot. I will fix the file.

Email to people who already use the model

Subject: a [job] skill, ten-minute install

I got tired of rewriting the same Claude chat every Friday, so I froze it. Instructions, a sample, a one-page install. \$19.

If you want it: [link].

If you do not, delete this.

Reply: Can't I just save a prompt?

You can. A skill pack is the instructions plus failure modes plus a sample so you know it loaded. If your saved prompt already asks for missing amounts and never invents them, you do not need this. If you rewrite the instructions every Friday, \$19 is cheaper than another Friday.

Reply: Does it work in ChatGPT?

This one is built for Claude Projects. I will not pretend it is the same in a Custom GPT. If you only use ChatGPT, do not buy this version. Refund if you already did.

Reply: Can you just set it up for me?

Yes, as a service, for a different price. This path is the zip. I will not throw a call into a \$19 product. If you want setup-for-hire, that is Custom project setups or Productized AI service.

Thread reply (help first)

I would not let it invent an amount. Ask once, then stop. Plain tone, not cute. If you want that frozen as a Claude Project, I put a \$19 zip in my profile. The stop rule is free.

Refund

You asked for a refund. Here it is, no speech. If you bought the Claude version and you only use ChatGPT, that is on my listing and I have made the tool name clearer. If the sample did not run, send a screenshot. I will fix the file for everyone else. You do not have to help. The refund is already processing.

Week-by-week if you have a job

Assume evenings. This is two weeks to a used skill, not a prompt brand.

Week 1, days 1-2: write and test

One job you already run. Write the instructions. Run a real example. Run a broken example. Save both. You can do this in two evenings after work. Do not design a landing page yet. Do not name it after yourself.

Week 1, day 3: package and checkout

README, skill file, sample in, sample out. Zip. \$19 Payment Link or Stan. Buy it from a second email. Record the 20-second screen on your phone if you have to. Filename after the job. Version v1.0 on the README.

Week 1, days 4-7: five asks, one post a day

Five personal messages. Post the screen recording once a day in one place — same clip, same offer. Help in two threads where people complain about the job. Link stays in the profile. Ask anyone who bought: did the sample run? Fix the install trip-up the same night.

Week 2: patch, then wait

Fix whatever the first buyer could not install. Ship v1.1. Email people who bought. Do not add a second skill until this one has a stranger sale. If nobody bought, the title or the tool is wrong. Ask one of the five: would you even install this? Then change the title, not the whole stack.

Week 3: teach the failure mode, three times

Three posts or emails that teach one stop rule. Soft link. Example: it asked for the missing amount instead of inventing it. End with \$19, ten-minute install, link in bio. If you are not public, send three more personal asks instead. Count: asks, sales, sample-ran, refunds and why. If refunds say wrong model, the listing is the bug.

Week 4: fix, do not expand

Date the README. Rerun the sample if the model moved. Email v1.1 or v1.2 to people who bought. Do not open a membership. Do not add a setup call to the \$19. A second skill only if a stranger asked for the next job.

Quality bar

Instructions that survive you leaving the room

Role in one line. Inputs named. Output format named. Three quality checks. A stop rule for missing facts. No be helpful filler. No claim that it replaces a bookkeeper, a lawyer, or a clinician. It drafts. They send.

The sample is real enough to trust

Blur names. Keep the ugly: a client who pays late every time, a line with a missing PO, a note in all caps. If the sample is a perfect table, the skill will look smart and fail on Friday.

Install a tired person can finish

One page. Numbered clicks. One screenshot if a menu is hidden. A line that says you will know it worked when the sample output looks like this. If they have to watch a 12-minute video, you wrote a course. Cut it.

Test 1: the install test

Hand the zip to someone who did not write it. Time them. Under ten minutes to a usable sample output, you passed. If they need you, the one-pager failed.

Test 2: the broken-example test

Missing amount, missing date, rude note. It asks once, then stops. If it guesses, rewrite the stop rule before you advertise.

Test 3: the voice test

If a buyer says it sounds like AI, the instructions need their voice. Add three sample sentences they actually send. Marcus put two real follow-ups he had already mailed (names changed) into SKILL.txt under match this tone. That killed the peppy bot voice.

Test 4: the claims test

No medical, legal, or financial claims. No skill that claims it is compliant. No this will collect the invoice. Operational drafting only. Put the limit in the instructions and on the listing. It drafts. They send.

Test 5: the model-name test

The title names the tool. The install names the clicks for that tool only. If two people refund because they use the other model, the listing failed, not the skill.

Below the bar

Prompts without install steps. A title with no job. A sample that is too clean. Instructions that guess at missing money. A 14-page install. Promising every model. If a tired person cannot run the sample in ten minutes, it is below the bar.

Metrics that matter (and vanity numbers to ignore)

Count these

Installs that produce a first output from the sample (ask: Did the sample run?)

Stranger sales at \$19

It broke emails — these are the roadmap

Time-to-install reports. If two people say it took 30 minutes, the one-pager failed

Refunds because of the wrong model. That is a listing problem. Fix the title.

Version number. If v1.0 never becomes v1.1, you are not talking to buyers.

Week 1

Count: instructions written, real example run, broken example run, zip opens, self-buy works, five asks sent. If the broken example still guesses, you do not have a product yet.

Day 30

Count asks, sales, stranger sales, sample-ran answers, break-emails, refunds-reason, version. A healthy day-30: sample runs, 5+ asks, 1+ stranger sale or at least one install without you, 0 to 1 refunds and those are listing problems you already fixed.

Day 90

Count v1.1 shipped (yes/no). Second skill (should still be no, unless a stranger asked for the next job). Cash in the \$19 to \$39 window, totaled. If you have \$0 at day 90, the failure is usually title, unnamed tool, or five asks you did not send. It is rarely the market.

Ignore these

Stars on a prompt marketplace. How many skills you listed. GitHub-style star counts. Views on the screen recording if nobody clicks the checkout. Lines of instructions. Community member counts you do not have yet.

One line a week

Date, asks sent, sales, break-emails, version number, one buyer sentence (did the sample run?). If the buyer sentence is always empty, you are not asking. Ask.

Objections you will hear

I already have a Custom GPT / a Project

Good. This is a better set of instructions plus a sample so they can test it. If theirs already does the job, they should not buy. If they keep tweaking it every week, \$19 is the freeze-frame that works.

Skills are going to be free from the labs

Some will be. Generic ones. A client-follow-up skill that knows a solo bookkeeper's tone and will not invent an amount is not on the default home screen. You are selling the job, not the concept of a skill.

I am not technical

Neither is the buyer, if you wrote the install. If you cannot write the install without the word repo, this path will hurt. Use Claude Projects or Custom GPTs, not a local install.

What if the model changes and it breaks

You version the file. You date the README: Tested on Claude, [month year]. You email v1.1 to people who bought. That is the job after the first sale. It is also why you do not sell 40 jobs in one zip — you cannot maintain them.

Can you just set it up for me

Yes, as a service, for a different price. This path is the zip. If you want setup-for-hire, that is Custom project setups or Productized AI service. Do not throw a call into a \$19 product.

Can't I just save a prompt

You can. A skill pack is the instructions plus failure modes plus a sample so you know it loaded. If your saved prompt already asks for missing amounts and never invents them, you do not need this. If you rewrite the instructions every Friday, \$19 is cheaper than another Friday.

Does it work in ChatGPT / Claude / Gemini

This one is built for [named tool]. I will not pretend it is the same in the other. If you only use the other, do not buy this version. Refund if you already did.

I need it connected to Gmail

That is Automation setups or Custom project setups, priced as a project. Do not promise inbox connection inside a \$19 zip.

Is \$19 too low if it saves a Friday every week

It is the right first price. Raise to \$29 to \$39 after a stranger has installed it and you have the screen and the failure modes. Do not start at \$79 with no proof.

What if Anthropic or OpenAI ships this exact skill

Then you sell the version that knows this job's tone and failure modes, or you move to the playbook and the service. Generic will always be free later. Specific stays yours if the sample is real.

How this feeds other paths

Upstream: what you need before this

You need a job you have already run in a model more than twice. If you have never run the job, write a playbook or take a service job first, then freeze the instructions from the scars.

Same job, other shapes

The instructions inside the skill are a Niche prompt stack if someone wants to paste instead of install. The sequence you used to build it is Sell an AI playbook. The checklist in the README is an AI template. Let the first buyers tell you which shape they asked for. Do not split until a stranger has installed v1.

Where it gets sold

AI-assisted short-form: the 20-second blank-vs-skill clip is the whole path. A weekly AI letter: one failure mode explained, link to the zip. Your front door: a diagnostic (do you rewrite the same Claude chat every Friday?) then the skill.

When it becomes a service or a membership

Local businesses + AI: install the same skill for a nearby owner and charge a setup fee. Custom project setups and Automation setups are the grown-up version for people who want it connected to their inbox. A small AI membership is how you send v1.2, v1.3 as the model changes — after the \$19 file has strangers using it. Do not open a membership to avoid shipping v1.

What not to feed yet

A GPT store listing as the first 72 hours. A catalog of six skills. Thirty days, one job, one tool in the title. After a stranger installs it, the next path is the one they asked for.

Mistakes that kill this path

I. Shipping prompts without install steps

Recovery this week: write the one-page install as clicks. Add it to the zip. Email v1.1.

2. Promising it works on every model

Recovery this week: pick one tool. Put it in the title. Refund anyone who bought the wrong one.

3. Bundling 40 jobs so none of them are good

Recovery this week: ship one job. Archive the rest. One appliance that works beats a store of toys.

4. Using other people's copyrighted prompt packs as your file

Recovery this week: stop listing it. Write the instructions from the job you actually do. The scar tissue is the product.

5. A title with no job

Recovery this week: rename. Client follow-up skill for solo bookkeepers, not Claude Power Pack. Same zip, new title, same \$19.

6. A sample that is too clean

Recovery this week: replace it with a messy real week, names blurred. Keep the missing PO and the all-caps note. Rerun. Save as SAMPLE.

7. Instructions that guess at missing money or medical facts

Recovery this week: add the stop rule. Ask once, then stop. Rerun the broken example. Do not ship a silent guesser. Invented numbers, invented legal language, a medical or legal skill that claims it is compliant: delete those claims. This path drafts operational writing. It does not practice. Put that limit in the instructions and on the listing.

8. A 14-page install or a 12-minute video

Recovery this week: cut to one page of clicks. One screenshot if a menu is hidden. Email v1.1.

9. Asking fifty people for features, or naming it after yourself

Recovery this week: stop the survey. Ask five people who already use the model to buy and install. Fix what they trip on. Rename the zip and the checkout after the job: bookkeeper-client-followup-claude-v1.zip.

10. A \$97 setup call, or a second skill before a stranger sale

Recovery this week: pull the call out of the \$19. If you want setup-for-hire, that is a different path at a different number. Close the other skill draft. Fix the install trip-up on this one. Send five new asks.

Tools and how you actually use them

Where the skill lives

Claude Projects: paste the instructions into the project. Custom GPTs: paste into the GPT builder instructions. Gemini Gems: same idea, different menu. Pick one for v1. Write the install for that one only. You are not shipping an API app. You are shipping text files a human pastes. If you need Zapier, you wandered into Automation setups.

Claude Projects, the actual clicks

Do this yourself before you write INSTALL. Write the clicks from the screen in front of you, not from memory.

Go to claude.ai. Log in. If Projects require Plus or Pro, say so on the listing. Do not sell a Project skill to a free account that cannot see the menu.

Open Projects from the left sidebar on desktop. On mobile, open the menu first.

New Project. Name it the job: Client follow-up.

Find custom instructions / Project instructions. Paste the entire SKILL.txt. Save. Do not paste SKILL into the chat. The chat is for raw material.

Do not upload SAMPLE-INPUT as a project file. Friday is a paste. The first message should still be a paste.

New chat inside the project. Paste SAMPLE-INPUT.txt. Send.

Compare to SAMPLE-OUTPUT.txt. Then paste a real list.

If Projects is not in their plan, do not sell them this zip. Refund. Or ship a Custom GPT version as a separate product after you have clicked it.

Custom GPTs, the actual clicks

Use this when your buyer lives in ChatGPT, not Claude. Do this yourself. Then write INSTALL from the screen.

Go to chatgpt.com. Log in. If creating a GPT requires Plus, say so on the listing.

On the left, GPTs, then Create. Or Explore GPTs, then Create.

Open the Configure tab, not only the chat-based Create tab. You want the Instructions box.

Name: Client follow-up for solo bookkeepers. Description: Paste an invoice list. Get send-ready emails. It will not invent amounts.

Instructions: paste the entire SKILL.txt.

Conversation starters: Paste your invoice list is enough. Do not add cute starters.

Knowledge: you may upload SAMPLE-INPUT.txt and SAMPLE-OUTPUT.txt so they can type run the sample. Still tell them to paste the sample as a message, because Friday is a paste, not a file hunt.

Capabilities: turn off web browsing if the job does not need it. Turn off image generation. This job is text.

Save. Only me while you test. Then Anyone with a link for buyers. You are not putting this in the public GPT store in week one.

Open the GPT. Paste SAMPLE-INPUT. Compare to SAMPLE-OUTPUT. The row with a missing amount must ask.

Your zip still contains SKILL.txt, SAMPLE-INPUT, SAMPLE-OUTPUT, and INSTALL. INSTALL names these clicks. Add a line: if ChatGPT moved the Create button, reply with a screenshot and I will bump INSTALL.

Gemini Gems, if that is where they live

Same idea. Gem instructions get SKILL.txt. First message is the raw list. Write INSTALL only if you actually use Gems for this job. Do not add a Gem appendix from a blog post you have not clicked. If you do not live there, do not sell there.

The zip and the page

Folder: README (the install), SKILL or INSTRUCTIONS, SAMPLE-INPUT, SAMPLE-OUTPUT. Zip it. Stripe Payment Link or Stan delivers the zip. That is the stack. Do not add a course platform.

The 20-second screen

Phone screen record is enough. Desktop is cleaner if the buyer is on desktop. Show the blank chat failing or stalling, then the skill succeeding on the same paste. No intro bumper. The still from second 3 is the thumbnail.

What not to buy

A course platform. A prompt marketplace membership. A local-install stack. Ads. A designer for a thumbnail that hides the job. A second checkout tool. You are selling a \$19 zip of text files.

The \$0 path

The model you already pay for (or the free tier, if it can hold project instructions). A text editor you already have. Zip from your file manager. Stripe Payment Link (cost per sale). Phone screen record. Five asks to people who already use the model. You do not need a new laptop, a microphone, or a developer account.

Setup order

Write the instructions in a plain file. Run a real example. Run a broken example. Write the one-page install. Zip four files. Create the payment link with that zip. Buy it from a second email. Record 20 seconds. Then ask five people. Do not set up a GPT store before the self-buy works. Do not compare six tools.

Ship checklist

Before you zip

One job in the title

One tool named (Claude Projects, Custom GPTs, or Gemini Gems)

Instructions: role, inputs, output format, quality checks, stop rules

Will not invent named fields (amounts, dates, diagnoses)

Real sample input and sample output

Broken-example test: it asked, then stopped

Three sample sentences of their voice, if a buyer would say it sounds like AI

One-page install with the actual clicks

One screenshot if a menu is hidden

Version number on the README

Filename after the job, not FINAL_v7

Tested-on line with month and year

Before you write INSTALL

You have clicked the install yourself this week, on the tool you named

The first message after install is only the raw material

You know which menu is hidden on mobile

You have a line that says you will know it worked when the sample matches SAMPLE-OUTPUT

If a step is set up your workspace, rewrite it as a click

Before you ask anyone

Zip opens on a phone

Checkout title = the job; price \$19

Tool named on the listing

Refund line on the page

Self-purchase from a second email

20-second screen recorded

Five names who already use the model

After-purchase three-line email written

No second skill, no 40-job bundle

No setup call inside the \$19

After the first install

Ask: did the sample run?

Fix the install trip-up

Ship v1.1 to people who bought

No second skill until a stranger sale

Log: date, asks, sales, break-emails, version

The night you list it

Checkout title matches the job

Tool is in line one of the listing

Link in the five messages is the live link

You bought it from a second email on a phone and the zip opened

Print the before-you-zip list. If a box is empty, that is tonight's work. Do not start a second SKILL.txt.

FAQ

Is this just a prompt pack?

No. A prompt pack is paste-as-you-go. A skill pack is installed once so the first message can be the raw material. If they want 25 separate prompts for a clinic week, that is Niche prompt stacks. If they want follow-up to live in Claude, that is this.

Claude, ChatGPT, or Gemini?

Pick the one you actually use for this job. Write for that one. Saying works everywhere is how you get refunds.

Do I need to code?

No. You need to write instructions and a one-page install. If you are building an API wrapper, you left this path.

What if Anthropic or OpenAI ships this exact skill?

Then you sell the version that knows this job's tone and failure modes, or you move to the playbook and the service. Generic will always be free later. Specific stays yours if the sample is real.

How many skills should I launch with?

One. Five asks. One stranger sale. Then a second skill only if they ask for the next job.

Can I put it on a GPT store or a skill directory?

After it works at \$19 on your own checkout. Directories are extra. They are not the first 72 hours.

What do I do when a buyer says it sounds like AI?

The instructions need their voice. Add three sample sentences they actually send. Marcus put two real follow-ups he had already mailed (names changed) into SKILL.txt under match this tone. That killed the peppy bot voice.

Is \$19 too low if it saves a Friday every week?

It is the right first price. Raise to \$29 to \$39 after a stranger has installed it and you have the screen and the failure modes. Do not start at \$79 with no proof.

What if they want it connected to Gmail?

That is Automation setups or Custom project setups, priced as a project. Do not promise inbox connection inside a \$19 zip.

Can I use someone else's skill as a base?

No. Do not use other people's copyrighted prompt packs as your file. Write the instructions from the job you actually do. The scar tissue is the product.

What do I do after five asks and zero sales?

Ask one of the five: would you even install this? Then look at the title and the tool name. Most first misses are a vibe title or a missing tool. Rewrite. Send five new asks. Do not rewrite the whole skill yet.

Should I include a setup call at \$19?

No. That is a service. Keep the zip at \$19. If you want to get paid for your time this week, use Productized AI service or Custom project setups.

How do I know the install is done?

A person who did not write it can finish it in under ten minutes and get a usable first output from the sample. Time someone. If they need you, add a screenshot. If they need a video, you overbuilt.

When do I bump the version?

When you fix install wording, add a screenshot, or change a stop rule. Put v1.1 in the README and the filename. Email people who already bought. Same checkout, new zip.

What if the buyer wants a ChatGPT version of my Claude skill?

That is a second product, after a stranger has installed this one. Do not pretend they are the same. If you build it, name the tool in the title and test it on that tool. Do not copy-paste the install clicks.

Do I need a landing page?

No. A Payment Link or Stan page whose title is the job is enough. A simple page that repeats the listing body is fine. Do not build a site instead of sending five asks.